this ‘trust deficit’ was essential to improve their relations.

Another FSLT was planned on 24th June, 2010 which was thought to be aiming at reducing this ‘trust deficit’ and, as advocated by India, to find “creative solutions” on Jammu and Kashmir and other issues to build on the progress made earlier through the Composite Dialogue and back channel diplomacy.

But before the June 2010 Indo-Pak talks, both countries got engaged in another major dispute. Both got set to fight a legal battle over Kishenganga power project under construction in J&K in an international court of arbitration. Pakistan is objecting to construction of 330 MW hydropower plant on Kishenganga, a tributary of the Jhelum under the 1960 Indus Water Treaty.

Uneasiness arose just before June 24, 2010 when Pakistani troops fired on Indian positions on the Line of Control in J&K, killing 2 civilians and injuring 2 jawans. However, India made it clear that it will focus on cross-border terrorism and would adopt “an exploratory approach” to work out steps to reduce post-Mumbai attack trust deficit between the two countries.

June 24, 2010 FSLT took place in Islamabad. Though there was no breakthrough, a positive step towards bridging the trust deficit between the two countries was made. During the talks, India raised the “core concern of terrorism” including the activities of the Laskar-e-Taiyyaba (LeT) and Jamaat-ud-Dawah (JuD) and Hafiz Muhammad Saeed. The other issue discussed was Pak’s concern about Indian presence in Afghanistan, and the Indian stand was clarified by making it related to the developmental works in Afghanistan. India, however, made it clear that attacks on Indian assets could not be allowed to continue as it affected relations between New Delhi and Islamabad. The FSLT, though not very substantial consequencewise, was not merely “exploratory” as both sides tried to “understand each others’ position”.

SAARC Home Ministers’ Meet, Islamabad, June 25, 2010 witnessed a meeting between Indian Home Minister Mr. P. Chidambaram and his Pakistani counterpart Mr. Rahman Malik during the conference. He was the first Indian Minister to visit Pakistan in three decades where he was accorded a red carpet welcome and a ceremonial